

Investment in General Practice 2008/09 to 2012/13 England, Wales, Northern Ireland and Scotland -Data Quality Statement

September 2013

Introduction

The Investment in General Practice report uses information obtained from country level financial monitoring reports and other published data on reimbursement and remuneration for dispensing activity. These are discussed by the Technical Steering Committee (TSC), which is chaired by the Health and Social Care Information Centre (HSCIC) and has representation from the UK Health Departments, NHS England, NHS Employers and the British Medical Association.

Information was provided to health departments by local providers in each of the countries, and therefore the accuracy of the original data lies with the organisations providing the data.

The health departments (Department of Health, England, Welsh Government, Department of Health, Social Services and Public Safety Northern Ireland and Scottish Government) collated the data to provide national level figures, and the information is then passed to the HSCIC. HSCIC also collates other published data on reimbursement and remuneration for dispensing activity in GP practices.

Accuracy

Figures are an accurate summary of how investment and spend on General Practice has changed over time. Information is provided to health departments by local providers as part of their audited statutory accounts. As part of the annual statutory accounts, the data is audited by appointed auditors therefore it can be considered to be accurate and reliable. Each country's Health Department also carefully checks the figures.

All results received from each of the countries are validated at a high level by the HSCIC before including in the publication and any anomalies are flagged up and discussed with TSC.

Relevance

Investment in General Practice data is used to collate investment in General Practice data, and enable comparisons by country. The publication meets these needs.

Compatibility and Coherence

Investment data is derived from different sources (the Health Departments across England, Wales, Northern Ireland and Scotland) and other published sources of dispensing expenditure. Data is comparable across countries.

Timeliness and punctuality

The report is published in September, therefore approximately 6 months after the financial year-end.

Accessibility

All reports are accessible via the HSCIC internet as PDF documents. The tables are available in CSV format.

Performance cost and respondent burden

The data used within the publication is a secondary use of the data and so adds no additional burden on the NHS. The data is obtained from administrative systems within each country.

Confidentiality, Transparency and Security

All publications are subject to a standard HSCIC risk assessment prior to issue. Disclosure control is implemented where judged necessary.

The data contained in this publication are Official Statistics. The code of practice is adhered to from collecting the data to publishing.

<http://www.statisticsauthority.gov.uk/national-statistician/ns-guidance-and-reports/national-statistician-s-guidance/index.html>

Please see links below to the relevant HSCIC policies.

Statistical Governance Policy

http://www.hscic.gov.uk/media/1350/Publications-Calendar-Statistical-Governance-Policy/pdf/The_HSCIC_Statistical_Governance_Policy_v3.1.pdf

Freedom of Information Process

<http://www.hscic.gov.uk/foi>